

PHULE
Brahmin groups alleged the film was anti-Brahmin, which is why the CBFC suggested caste names in the film be changed to just lower caste

versy around *Phule* was Anurag Kashyap, who took to Instagram to vent his rage in a series of stories. After the film failed to release on the initial date of April 11 to coincide with Phule's birth anniversary, he wrote: "*Bhai India mein* caste *to* exist *hi nahin karti. Dhadak 2 mein bhi yahi bola tha. Hamare* leaders *ne* India *mein* caste system *khatam kar diya hai. Baaki jinko nahin dikhta, woh chu**** hain* [There's no caste system in India. They said the same in *Dhadak 2*. Our leaders have eliminated the caste system. Those who don't see it are fools.]

"We have changed the name of the board, giving the impression that it's a certifying board, but we have not dropped the censorship"
ANANTH MAHADEVAN
Filmmaker



Kashyap was referring to Shazia Iqbal's caste-centric romantic drama *Dhadak 2*, a Dharma produced adaptation of the critically acclaimed Tamil drama *Pariyerum Perumal*. The primary reason for its repeated delays—from November 2024 to March 2025 to an as yet undisclosed date—is reportedly that it too has come under the CBFC scanner for the caste discrimination it showcases. A teaser of the film, released nearly 11 months ago, shows slogans like 'Dalit Lives Matter' and 'Revolution' and states that the love story centres on a couple (starring Triptii Dimri and Siddhant Chaturvedi) of opposing castes. With no clarity on whether it has received a certification from the examining committee, its wait to release on the big screen is further prolonged. *Dhadak 2* for Dharma is a franchise that continues the theme of forbidden love that began with *Dhadak* (2018), a remake of the Marathi blockbuster *Sairat*, which was an ill-fated romance between a lower-caste boy and an upper-caste girl.

While *Dhadak 2* still holds out hope



DHADAK 2
Like *Phule* now, *Dhadak 2* too is reportedly facing heat from the CBFC for its depiction of caste prejudice

L2: EMPURAAN
Even after CBFC clearance, scenes depicting atrocities on Muslims in the 2002 Gujarat riots were cut and a character's name changed after irate Hindutva groups accused the film of being anti-Hindu